gave me her phone but told me to keep it short, as she didn't have much airtime left.

This annoyed me even more, and I had a go at her, saying, 'In that case, you keep your bladdy phone.' Obviously that didn't make her too happy. I believe 'ungrateful little shit' was among the colourful phrases she used. Ja … I didn't make any friends there.

Anyway, they then put me back into the van and took me back to the Sea Point station, where I was chucked into a cell. Another guy was already in the cell, also for drunk driving. I must have been locked up for a couple of hours, but I don't remember too much beyond loudly singing the Engelbert Humperdinck classic 'Please Release Me, Let Me Go' at the top of my voice and then passing out. I dossed like a champion.

Out of the fog I heard someone calling my name: 'Mr Gibbs … Mr Gibbs … Mr Gibbs …' It was about seven in the morning when I was allowed to go, and by then there were some reporters outside the police station. Obviously someone from the police had tipped them off … That's how they managed to get a photo of me, which appeared in the paper the next morning.

As it turned out, the charges against me were dropped a year later. Not too long after that incident I decided, however, to drop my marriage. 'Well, this is it,' I said to myself. 'Just stop all the shit and stop putting Tenielle through this.' She was too nice a woman, and I couldn't keep doing bad things to her. I needed to break the cycle. I think she was also starting to lose patience with my drinking.

I decided I just couldn't be in the relationship any more. By now I was thinking, 'No more marriage,' but not, interestingly enough, 'No more drinking.' I knew it was pointless for me to continue with the marriage. Despite my good intentions, I knew I just wasn't equipped or ready for it.

I still loved Tenielle – I probably always will – but the more I thought about it, the more I realised that it just wasn't the right time for me to be married. As a professional sportsman who played international cricket, I wasn't at home long enough to actually work on the relationship. If one partner in a marriage is home for only a few months of the year, it follows that the relationship is going to struggle. You simply don't spend enough time with your partner to actually build a strong bond.

When we first got married, I started feeling very claustrophobic after only a couple of weeks, despite the fact that I'd also been away for a month.